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THE CHARACTERISTICS OF MASOCHISM *

by

Dr. Theodor Reik

(New York)

Are there any characteristic elements possessed in common and invariably found in the different forms of masochism? The sexological and psychological literature surely offers sufficient observational material—often one might believe too much—but even today the assertion may be ventured that the phenomenology of masochism has not yet been adequately investigated. That is to say there is still lacking a description of the peculiar features of masochism in its usual forms.

It will be worth while to cite some illustrative material. In the selecting of examples the primary consideration will be that there can be no doubt of their masochistic character. The differences as to sex will be as little considered as the question of whether it concerns a masochistic phantasy or an actual scene of perversion. The three following examples may from this standpoint claim to be representative of the essentials.

A young girl had the following phantasy which showed in the course of many years but trivial variations: it is late evening, she goes through the streets to the butcher-shop which has already closed its shutters. She knocks, when the butcher opens the shutters she says: "Please, I would like to be butchered." He grants her request and lets her in. She undresses at the back of the store and lies down naked on the meatblock. She has to lie there a long time waiting. The butcher is busy cutting up some calves. Once in a while one of his fellow workmen comes by and grasps her body and tests the flesh like an expert testing an animal to be slaughtered. Finally the butcher himself comes and he also tests with his fingers various portions of her body, hauling her about for this purpose as if she were a dead calf. He grabs the butcher knife but before he makes a cut puts his finger in her vagina. At this moment she has an orgasm.

The unquestionably masochistic phantasy of this woman can be compared with its counterpart from a man: a 37 year old father

* Translated by Dr. G. Wilbur.

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of three children is sexually potent only with the aid of an especially widespread and varied set of phantasies. From among them I will select one at random: To a barbaric idol somewhat like the Phoenician Moloch there is to be sacrificed over a lengthy period a great number of young athletes. They will be undressed and laid on the altar one by one. There is heard the rumble of drums to which are joined the songs of the temple choir. The highpriest followed by other priests approaches. He tests with a critical eye each of the young men. They must satisfy certain requirements as to beauty of form and athletic appearance. The highpriest takes the genital of each victim in his hand and tests its weight and form. Many of the young men will be rejected as distasteful to the god or unworthy of being sacrificed, if the genitals are not pleasing to the priest. The highpriest gives the order for the execution and the ceremony continues. With a sharp cut the genitals and surrounding parts are cut away. The patient who belongs to the visualizing type is able to picture to himself very plastically the progress of the scene. He is himself not a participant, only an onlooker.

Here the question might be raised whether such a phantasy is masochistic or sadistic. During the phantasy, which was used at first in masturbation and only later was called into aid in intercourse with his wife, the ejaculation occurred at the moment when the highpriest showed the knife. The decision as to whether a phantasy is primarily masochistic or is more sadistic in character must be based on information as to whom the person identifies with. In our case it was certain that the day-dreamer identified with one of the victims, usually not the one who was being castrated but with the next who was obliged to look on at the execution of his companions. The patient shared every strong affect of these victims, felt their terror and anxiety with all its signs since he imagined that he himself would experience the same fate in a few moments.

Rather than take the third example from the field of phantasy we will select an actual instance of masochistic perversion. A middle aged man goes from time to time to a prostitute and carries out the following scene: on entering he asks her if she gives Russian lectures. The word is used for masochistic practices in an-

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nouncements in certain newspapers of his country. In the mind of the patient the expression connotes the terrors of pogroms and scenes in Russian prisons which he has read about. If the girl says yes, he tells her what she has to do. She must scold him as if he were a little boy who has been naughty or has committed some misdeed. She must say to him that he deserves a severe beating with a club and so on. He exposes himself obediently and receives a blow on the buttocks. In many instances the blow is unnecessary since the ejaculation has already occurred. In coitus the patient was impotent.

It is not to be doubted that these three examples are representative of masochism as a perversion. It is perhaps accidental that in none of them does the sensation of pain or the perception of it play any kind of role or receive any significance. Even in the phantasy of the execution of the young men there can be no question of pleasure in picturing that, rather is the pleasure in the idea of the anxiety and terror. What was pleasurable in the ideas, we should remember, was the fright the next victim must feel at the moment of castration of his predecessor. The castration itself appeared in the phantasies merely as a surgical operation. No stress was laid on the sensation of pain.

If we have excluded then, the pleasure in pain as an inevitable element what remains as a common factor? Surely everything else that hitherto was considered as characteristic of masochism: the passive nature, the feeling of impotence and the submission to another person, the terrible, degrading and shameful treatment by this person and the sexual excitement which appears in consequence of this treatment. There is nothing new in all this. Yet we intend to produce something new, something not previously disclosed as characteristic or at least something which has been insufficiently valued. These characteristics must appear as those which necessarily and inevitably constitute the essence of masochism. Naturally they do not always appear in the same form nor with the same intensities, yet they are always present. Where they are lacking we cannot speak of masochism. In what follows I wish to describe three such constituent elements, which can be demonstrated in masochism as a perversion as well as in its desexualized forms. They are: the *peculiar significance of phantasy,* the necessity of a distinctive course of excitement or the *sus-*

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pense factor, and the *demonstrative character* of the phenomena. It will also appear that these three factors are intimately associated, that they are only different modes of expression of a more deeply hidden essential.

The Significance of Phantasy for Masochism

If we review the examples cited above feature by feature, then the significance of the phantasy as a preparation for and means of producing sexual tension cannot be doubted. The young girl in the butchershop scene must wait, until the butcher has finished his other business. When he turns to her, first must come the testing of the meat, then the feeling of and hauling about of the body. The prisoner in the phantasy of the young men must participate in all the religious ceremonials, experience the slow approach of the priests, the preparations for the execution and the castration of his comrades. He must listen to the cries of anguish of the other victims, must share in their moanings and writhings. The prelude to the scene which the masochist plays with the prostitute is more important than the blow on the buttocks. The entrance, the speech, question and answer, the scolding, the forced and yet desired exposure of the person, the waiting for punishment were the features designated by the patient himself as those most important and essential for producing pleasure.

This peculiar significance of phantasy for the masochistic excitement is demonstrable not only in the later forms. It can be observed already in the original scenes which gave rise to the perversion. For example, take the basic scene in the case of the young Dutch girl. As a child she had lived in the neighborhood of a slaughterhouse. Because of his trade the parents would not associate with the butcher although he was an uncle. This circumstance may have contributed to the fact that the activities of this uncle had a mysterious significance for the child and her somewhat older brother. The two had many opportunities to watch the activities of the butcher-uncle and his fellow workmen. The children watched closely when their uncle cut up animals and then played, in the garden attached to the house, a game of "slagertje" (Dutch for butcher). The little girl laid on the bench in the garden and the brother carried on like a butcher. First he was busy elsewhere, came at last to where his sister lay and

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played at cutting her up as he had seen his uncle do. With light flat strokes of the extended open hand he cut the body—still clothed—into pieces. The preliminaries to the procedure were themselves already in some dim way pleasure-toned for the girl. The light blows on the body produced sensations in the clitoris. The example shows that already in the situation where the masochism originated phantasy is significant for sexual stimulation, or speaking more exactly, is so in one of the situations decisive for its genesis. To wait to be slaughtered, an anticipation of being handled, stirred up, even at that time, a sexual tension in the little girl.

Another requirement is satisfied by the masochistic phantasy when, as in my patient's Moloch scene, it anticipates terrible future possibilities. The material for this phantasy was again easily recognizable as a working over of childhood ideas. The religious clothing came from later years and showed the traces of the effects of a varied reading. When the patient was a small boy his some years older brother was operated on for a phimosis and later showed the little one his wound. The later phantasies of the boy sprang from his impressions then, and were directed at his good but stern father before whom he felt very helpless and afraid. He must have assumed at that time, that he also later like the brother would have his penis operated on by his father or by a doctor. In this idea appear homosexual stirrings which had mixed with those springing from the need for punishment and became arrested as a reaction to masturbation. In the Moloch phantasy there is to be recognized in the young men before the altar a series of brothers among whom he has his place. It is a noteworthy characteristic that he identifies with the one who watches the operation and experiences the anxiety of him who is next.

Nevertheless, is the significance of phantasy for sexual stimulation actually so surpassing just in masochism? Its role in normal sexual life is certainly also not denied a degree of importance. Does masochism show a departure here from other perversions in which the preliminaries of a desired situation are demonstrably so prevalent in phantasy? It is indeed the essence of perversion that the phantasies linger on the preparatory activities instead of progressing to genital satisfaction. We may compare, then, the

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significance which phantasy has in the sexual stimulation in sadism and in peeping. Naturally also in the sadist and the voyeur the situation desired comes about in phantasy and through such ideas produces a sexual tension. It would seem then that the difference reduces to a plus and minus of the excitability. However, this is not the case. The difference is rather, that the masochist cannot miss the phantasy, that it represents a preliminary which is indispensible, a condition *sine qua non*. The sadist or the voyeur is also capable of satisfaction without such preparation. If a voyeur out walking, let us say, in the woods has opportunity to see a woman exposed, no preliminary phantasy is necessary to produce in him strong sexual excitement. Compare with this the situation about as it would be in a masochist. Let us assume that his specific condition for excitement is to receive a box on the ear from a corpulent woman and to be cursed at. Let us assume further, that this situation eventuates without preparation, that is, without the usual preliminary phantasies. The man in question, let us say, goes peaceably out on the street, a huge woman comes up to him, showers him with words of abuse and gives him a mighty box on the ear. To give the scene some verisimilitude it is only necessary to assume that the poor man is the victim of a mistaken identity. The woman so prone to strike believes she has recognized in him a man who had wronged her.

Will the masochist be sexually stimulated by the sudden attack? That is almost impossible. Of course it is quite possible, that the scene will subsequently be used in phantasy to produce sexual stimulation, but its momentary effect will not be of this sort even though it exactly reproduces a desired situation. This assumed situation is designed to make clear the significance of phantasy for the masochistic gratification. Here the assertion is not, that phantasy is not essential as a preparation in the other perversions, but that for masochism it is absolutely indispensible.

Yet there are two objections to such an opinion. The first would bring up that phantasy is of especial importance as a preliminary in exhibitionism. Experience shows that this is really the case. We are thus compelled to make a correction and are obliged to say: in the perversions with a passive instinctual goal there is a particular necessity for a preliminary phantasy in order that

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sexual excitement may be attained. Psychologically this is quite intelligible, for these perversions depend not alone on the will of the person in question but as much or even more on the will of the particular object. It is left to this partner, how one shall react. If his reaction is not the desired one, then no or only a slight sexual effect is produced. This reaction is more important for the masochist and the exhibitionist than for the sadist and the voyeur, who are less dependent on the behavior of their partner. It has been reported that once in some woods near Paris an exhibitionist suddenly appeared to an English woman and—it was at a lonely spot on a winter evening—exposed his genitals. The woman with great presence of mind went up to him and said: "My good man, won't you catch cold?" One may venture to assume that this thoughtfulness had a very moderating effect. For all that it is not quite the case that phantasy is as important for the exhibitionist as for the masochist. A group of young girls who have just come along the path can instantly bring it about that the exhibitionist decides to expose himself.

Another objection has it that in certain cases the sudden appearance of a detail can suffice to generate a masochistic excitement. Thus a colleague referred me to a case treated by him in which the beating of a dog became the central point of a masochistic phantasy. Later the mere sight of a dog whip was sufficient to produce sexual excitement in the patient. It thus appears that in such a case a frank preliminary phantasy is needless. But this is only the appearance, for in actuality the preparation is very extensive and of ancient date. The material has been gone over so often, that everything is prepared. The glimpse of the dog-whip is simply the factor that stirs into activity this already prepared psychic material. Such a glimpse reminds us of something that can come forward at any moment because it is always ready. It is exactly as when we hear faintly touched on the piano the first notes of an old familiar melody. As a counter-part I would refer to the patient with the Moloch phantasy cited above. A low degree of sexual excitement could be detected by him when he saw strong young men in certain postures, indeed sometimes, even when he merely looked at their photograph. These postures had to be of the sort that reminded him of the posture of the victim in the Moloch

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phantasy. Thus the form of a young man lying on a couch brought back to him, with the corresponding sexual excitement, the image of the sacrificial victim on the altar of the terrible idol. The objection then is not so strong as it would seem. There is in these cases not a less but a greater degree of phantasy preparation. The fetishistic mechanism which is effective in such cases is the well known displacement on to a detail, whereby the detail becomes a substitute for and representative of the whole. In this there is nothing peculiar to the excitability of any perversion. The sexual erotogenic effects of such surrogate details can be shown also in the field of normal sexuality. A trifling sketch in a recent newspaper pictured a young woman stopping on a street corner to fix her garter. For this purpose, of course, she had to raise her skirt a bit. One of two men happening to pass by remarks to the other: "It's not much, but it gives you a kick."

The objections we have considered were not adequate to make us revise our opinion. It still stands then that the preliminary phantasy has an especial importance for masochism. The phantasy is the primary thing. Masochistic practices are only an acting out of preceding phantasies. Every thorough analysis shows that the masochistic perversion is a realization in practice of imagined situations with which the person has long concerned himself. The actual scene corresponds thus to the staging of a drama and is related to the phantasy as is the performance to the dramatist's conception. It is exposed to the same accidents and necessary adaptations to the means at hand and is just as dependent on the mood and concurrence of the actors. Only rarely does the performance surpass the ideas of the author. More often, even as with the masochistic scene, it falls short of the conception. It is in accordance with the theatrical element in masochism that it seldom becomes a matter of "deadly earnest" as with the sadistic perversion.

Some unconnected remarks about the peculiarities of masochistic phantasy are here in order. A particular feature is the tendency to synchronization, an admirable expression I obtained from the patient with the Moloch phantasies. A phenomenon he had observed in himself was that the sexual excitement ran a temporal course corresponding completely to the course of events

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in the phantasy which, incidently, proceeded at a pace in such consonance with his feelings that it was clear he identified masochistically with the victim. Thus the ejaculation always occurred in the Moloch phantasy at approximately the same place, when the highpriest produced the knife.

Striking and certainly in keeping with the essence of masochism is the conservativism or tenacity of the phantasy. Masochistic situations are frequently maintained for years with little or no change and are found in the phantasies to remain exciting. Such alterations as do occur are usually restricted to trifling displacements and substitutions of persons, times and places while the main theme, if it may be called such, is adhered to. After long intervals, however, great and very extensive alterations are introduced bringing about a complete change of theme, a process comparable perhaps to the reform in an old institution produced by the introduction of efficiency. The masochistic situation appears to be wholly altered. The new content in turn will be maintained for a long time and with little variation. At intervals the old "worn out" phantasies obtrude again into the picture. It is thus possible to distinguish long periods during which the psychic processes are dominated by this or that sharply circumscribed phantasy content. The patient referred to above spoke of these phantasy groups as "cycles." So he could speak of the period of the Aztec cycle during which he was sexually excited by the idea of the sacrifice of prisoners in the Aztec kingdom, or of the queen cycle, a phantasy group in which a terrible empress subjected her lovers to horrible torments and so on. One gets the impression that after a long while the masochistic phantasy loses its exciting quality and is superseded. It was only after considerable analytic experience that I became convinced that this tenacity of phantasy is characteristic of masochism.

It is noteworthy that masochistic phantasy and action are not restricted to the visual field. According to my impressions speech also plays a great part. There are verbal masochists who become sexually excited when they are insultingly abused or humiliated. These situations are frequently anticipated and enjoyed in their phantasies. If the scene should then become actual, the masochist will expect and hope to hear just those insulting and abusive

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words of which a certain choice, succession or emphasis appears important for great sexual stimulation.

The material in masochistic phantasies is more frequently capable of extension and circumscription than in other perversions. It can assume the form of a story and bring many people on its phantasy stage to act and suffer. It frequently finds support in the patient's reading, the influence of which can be clearly detected in its conformation. In one case observed by me the phantasies of a school boy took as a point of departure for many situations that of Marsyas who was flayed by Apollo. This nucleus proved to be so strong and persistent that twenty years later in altered form it still exercised its exciting effect when the man saw in the Brussels Museum the picture by David of the flaying of the judge Marsyas.

Related to a characteristic to be discussed shortly, the factor of suspense, is the fact that masochistic phantasies cling to, select or test out details. The fact is, however, that the different pictures or scenes undergo a selection according to their capacity for producing sexual excitation and if they do not prove adequate are discarded, as in a kaleidoscope different individual pictures appear and persist for a longer or shorter period. Naturally it occurs that some aspects of the phantasy are effective for long periods and are later rejected depending on a diminution of the sexually stimulating value. To the conservatism of the masochistic phantasy then, there is opposed a need for variation which represents only an expression of the psychic alterations in the phantasying person. Whether a phantasy "succeeds" or not depends on various factors. A successful phantasy is, of course, one giving or accompanied by a satisfactory orgasm. With other phantasies there is none or, at most, a flat orgasm.

It is not always clear beforehand with whom the phantasying person identifies. Surely with the victim, the passive person in the phantasy, but also with the active terrible figure, frequently also with a nonparticipating onlooker, though one to whom is known the feelings of the active and of the suffering figures. The often quoted stanza of the masochisticially inclined Charles Baudelaire:

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11 "Je suis la plaie et le couteau!
Je suis le soufflet et la joue!
Je suis les membres et la roue,
Et la victime et le bourreau!"

L'Heautontimoroumenos. Le Fleurs du Mal. Edition critique Paris 1917.

is in this sense incomplete. The masochist is in his phantasies the spectator at the execution and experiences the pleasure of watching which clearly seems to be an attenuated or displaced sadistic gratification.

The property of evoking sexual excitation is certainly not the only factor involved in the selection of the images referred to above. Other factors such as conformity with the reality situation are influential. Frequently the imagination dwells on the details until they shall seem to conform to reality, arranges and alters the situation until it shall show no gross contradiction with other details. It is the more striking then, that at other times the phantasying person is completely indifferent to such considerations. In the Moloch phantasy, for instance, the patient many times dwelt for long on the idea of a red-hot grill, on which the victims were to be laid, striving to make this detail technically correct in all particulars. On the contrary he gave no thought to the great anachronisms introduced into his phantasy; impossibilities with respect to time and place were, of course, not hidden to his observation but they didn't concern him. This attitude could be compared to the behavior of a poet who sometimes brings his story into conformity with some particulars of an historic event only to permit himself great poetic license at other points. This patient, for instance, had had a long and extensive interest in Mexico and Peru, knew not only the general works dealing with these lands but also special investigations on their sacrificial rites and had even himself searched the remains of these dead cultures for altars, temples and so on. Of course, he was well aware that the ritual sacrifice with the Aztecs was not a castration, nevertheless in his phantasies he insisted on the notion of castration which excited him. As an example of such a phantasy: an English officer has fallen into the hands of the ancient Aztecs, who periodically make ceremonial sacrifice of prisoners to the god by castrating them. Up to the moment of execution the prisoner dwells in the

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house of the man who captured him and who also will officiate at the sacrifice. On one occasion he takes the officer who in general is treated in a very friendly manner, into a room in which are displayed as trophies the genitalia of earlier victims. At this point there enters into the phantasy a characteristic hesitation or deliberation: just how are the genitals displayed? In the beginning the patient imagined that they were deposited in a chest. This idea was rejected in the course of the phantasy because the flesh would become decayed and shrunken. Also the possibility of their being stuffed like a dead bird was discarded. The phantasier finally decided they should be preserved in bottles of alcohol. Here is the covert intrusion of a childhood experience, the bit of reality from which the whole started. As mentioned above the older brother of the patient, who was four years old at the time, was operated on because of a phimosis. The youngster must in his imagination have connected the operation with a cutting off of the penis. Later on he could persuade himself by looking that the penis of the brother although wounded was still present, but this impression was presumably less strong than the earlier one which had the character of reality for his phantasies. Some years later the old impression must have been reanimated when the same brother underwent an operation for appendicitis. This time the patient was shown the amputated appendix preserved in alcohol. Here then is that feature out of the reality which has crept back into the phantasies incognito by way of a detour. Some of the material out of which the phantasy was constructed is clearly recognizable. The doubt relating to the detail about the means of preservation represents surely the one then arising in the child, and probably others still preserved in the Unconscious of the adult: if father castrates his son, will I also be castrated? The patient's attitude to his phantasies was ambiguous, on the one hand he devoted to their elaboration a great deal of energy and cleverness, on the other he found them ridiculous and was ashamed of them and did not understand why such grotesque stuff could so intensively occupy his mind and excite him.

It has already been pointed out that the scenes which the masochist carries into effect, which they stage so to speak, are composed of phantasies into which new features can now and again be in-

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serted and old ones refurbished for the purpose of attaining the greatest stimulating effect. If one may trust countless impressions gained in analytic practice, then the exciting phantasy first originates spontaneously, only later will it be deliberately invoked for the sake of excitement. So it seems as if masochism as a perversion has its genesis also in phantasies which developed out of a germ of reality. However important the later development may be, the significance of phantasy for masochistic excitement will also in later phases be not less important. If in the beginning in accompaniment to a phantasy an erection of the penis happens to occur then later it is not rarely the case that when an erection reoccurs, the phantasy which has remained unconscious, is called in to reaccompany it.

Peculiar is the course the phantasy takes in the life of the individual with the desexualized form of masochism. At first sight it would appear to be completely lacking or at least without significance. But this is correct only in so far as in these cases there is seldom a cultivation of particular phantasies which then get some satisfaction in the fate of the individual and contribute visibly to a masochistic gratification. Phantasying as a discernible separate activity has to be sure become obscure and is hardly perceptible. However, it has spread out over the whole life and fate of the individual and plays its destined role as, for instance, in the martyr. The life configuration in such an individual is based on an unconscious phantasy, only rarely on the ramifications of a possibly conscious one of masochistic sort in which the phantasying person appears as the victim of a hostile or adverse fate. In place of the sexual partner who inflicts degradation and abuse there appear more impersonal forces which hinder the individual in the attainment of his life purpose and ever again bring him into a situation of frustration or of renunciation, by threats of disappointment and disgrace. In place of the masochistic suffering which stimulates sexually there show up the blows of destiny. Since the whole life story is carried out in terms of a phantasy which conditions every aspect, the individual is spared the necessity of elaborating an isolated masochistic one. In masochism in all its forms then, we note as the feature of primary importance the especial significance of phantasy.

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A peculiarity of the masochistic achievement of pleasure.

The other characteristic feature of masochism is an especial form of getting sexual gratification which, hitherto, has received at most inadequate or superficial consideration. The tension is the clearest indication of the phenomenon. Two features show up here and are demonstrably different from anything in normal sexuality: the preponderance of the anxiety factor and the tendency to prolongation of the act. The sexual tension in masochistic experience shows more strongly than in the normal a vacillation between the pleasurable and the anxious and a tendency to being maintained as long as possible, in opposition to the natural impulse towards discharge. Apparently there is an intrinsic relation between these two features. First of all one is tempted to assume that the vacillation between anxiety and pleasure brings to expression an uncertainty which is designed to avoid a decision. However, a deeper insight into the psychic facts corrects this guess. While in normal sexual life the tension shows no note of anxiety or, at least, none worth speaking about, this is a regular feature in the experience of the masochist. This bit of anxiety always receives support either in the phantasy or in the scene itself. There is a difference between the normal and the masochistic tension-curve which in English can be made clear in a word. For the curve of normal sexual excitement the word "tension" (Spannung) is completely adequate, for the other the best designation is "suspense." These two words may be contrasted. Tension denotes a simple state of excitation in which there is a tendency to reach a climax which, it is self-evident, will be subsequently discharged. Suspense on the contrary connotes the element of the uncertain, the hesitating, the being poised and at the same time the idea that there is no definite duration or termination to this state. One can speak of an "agony of suspense" thus designating the painful, even unbearable element in it. But the words can also designate the expectations of children as they sit watching the closed door on Christmas eve awaiting the appearance of Saint Nicholas with his presents. The public that awaits the verdict of the jury is in "suspense" just as is the reader of a detective story. The German language knows no corresponding expression. At best perhaps the "Hangen und Bangen" of Goethe approximates like "sus-

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pense" to something of the quality of pleasurable anxiety of a state of excitation. It is certainly no accident that being hung on some kind of contraption is one of the masochistic practices. It is described by perverse devotees as affording an especial pleasure. Presumably it gives a functional objectivity to the suspense sensation.

The second characteristic of the tension-curve in masochism is a tendency to prolongation of the state while the opposite intention of resolving the tension is subordinated. We will put it cautiously: it seems as if such an intention existed in masochism. From a superficial point of view it is possible to believe that the masochist strives to prolong the pleasure and consequently drags out the tension in the sense of all pleasure: "For joys all want—eternity." * But this is only the appearance; a more critical investigation shows that his striving is to prolong the forepleasure, or what is more important, to avoid the end-pleasure. Here masochism can be distinguished from all of those other perversions which cling to the stage of the fore-pleasure. In masochism the end-pleasure is avoided *because it involves anxiety.*

The postponement and ultimate renunciation of the end-pleasure can easily be explained by an analogy: we all know children who leave a bit of food of which they are especially fond until the last. If this tendency to reserve the best of the food for the end continues such a habit could appear to a teacher as a valuable asset for life. In the meantime he should not overlook the danger which results from the hypertrophy of this practice: that the child finally renounces entirely that particular bit of food. The reservation has become a renunciation, from the training in self-control an ascetic characteristic. I know of a case in which a youngster put a Swiss pastry of which he was very fond into a box to preserve it and kept up a continual struggle against his desire to eat it. When finally he did decide to do so and after several days opened the box he found the chocolate cake quite spoiled.

The corresponding sexual behavior is not uncommonly observed at puberty: a typical form of masturbation consists in avoiding discharge by interrupting the manual activity and diverting the thoughts. After a while the masturbation is resumed and

* F. Nietzsche, Thus Spake Zarathustra, p. 321, Modern Library Edition.

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the excitement again cut off just before ejaculation. The youth given to this sort of masturbation frequently does this for the sake of maintaining the sexual pleasure as long as possible but the result is usually that ejaculation occurs prematurely and without satisfaction or is entirely omitted: thus there is renunciation of the end-pleasure of orgasm.

It is clear that this putting off or better, this evasion of the end-pleasure conforms to the peculiar character of the suspense-feeling. On the one side the end-pleasure is desired and longed for, on the other and for very dim reasons it is avoided. In cases of advanced masochistic attitude there results from the conflict of these two strivings a psychic situation which gives to the course of excitement that characteristic vacillation between the pleasurable and the fearful, a pleasurable-displeasure, if one may use the paradoxical expression and the obsolete meaning of the word, which superficially seems to indicate that the masochist wishes to be free of the sexual tension and yet cling to it, "to eat his cake and have it." The result is that he loses it, or rather that it leaves him in the lurch. The striving for pleasure tapers off into discontent, into a pleasureless ejaculation or in a dissipation of the tension without gratification.

In the suspense-factor can be recognized the stamp which masochism puts on sexuality. In it the alloying of the striving for pleasure with torture of the self becomes complete. The result "earth's insufficiency here grows to Event:" * In masochism the typical course of sexual excitement then will be that the tension never becomes so great as to flow over into a satisfying orgasm, rather it is maintained as suspense.

The suspense factor finds expression either in the phantasies or in the course of the excitement during masochistic practices. Here an example of its working out is pertinent. Take one of the phantasies from the Moloch series referred to above. It has the following content: a line of young men are to be sacrificed to Moloch by being burned. They will be put one by one on a grill which is movable and under which the great fire of Moloch gleams. The victims hang above the grill, the parts of their bodies which come in contact with it are singed. The question with which the phan-

* Chorus Mysticus Faust II Act V Trans. Bayard Taylor.

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tasy is concerned is: can the young men remain hanging until they are burned bit by bit or will they fall into the flames to seek a quick and merciful death? Or rather, how long can they submit to the torture before they "let go" voluntarily and fall into the fire? By recalling that the patient generally identified himself with the next victim and experienced also his predecessor's hanging in the suspense of expectation that this would soon be his fate, the extension of the moment of suspense can be seen. If the "synchronization" is successful, ejaculation occurs at the moment when, in the phantasy, the victim finally lets go. Another phantasy of this same patient was built up on a detail taken from the book of Dias de Castello: a Portuguese, one of several prisoners taken by the Aztecs, has to wait eighteen days before being killed as the last of the prisoners, meanwhile he watches the execution of his friends. The suspense factor in this instance was usually provided by ruminations as to how or which part of the body would be the first to be cut out of a living person, which part would be next, how long a man could stand this before he became powerless and so on. These fragments of the phantasy were suggested by the Marsyas myth. The technical details of the grill over Moloch's fire were thought over, turned this way and that, while the sexual excitement calmed down or ebbed away. As a feminine counterpart may be cited the phantasy of a patient who imagined she was threatened with the wearing of a tight cast or of a very constricting corset. The grip of the apparatus which she must endure more and more stimulated in her imagination a strong sexual excitement which she could maintain for long at a peak. The starting point of this set of ideas was an historic event: as a small girl with a bad posture she had to wear for a long time at the command of the mother an orthopedic cast. This historic substratum was reinforced when the half-grown girl some years later began to carry on a wrestling game with an older brother. In this game the shoulders of the vanquished had to be forced to the ground where, according to the rules they had to remain for a certain time. The girl would defend herself desperately but was obliged eventually both in the figurative and in the real sense of the words to "lie down." The suspense sensation was here tied up with the phantasied course of the wrestling match.

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and the time of the lying there. There was always the chance that the brother would not force her down or that she while lying on the ground would still be able to raise her shoulders.

It seems, I said, as if the masochist wishes to avoid letting the tension mount to the point of orgasm. The explanation lying close to hand, is, that the end-pleasure is avoided because it is associated with an anxiety. In the further course of events and by displacement of the anxiety the increase in the tension which could lead to orgasm is avoided also. Generally only as the final result of this development does impotence set in, a condition we find so frequently with the masochist. But the way to the solution of the problem is closed if we simply assume, as did Wilhelm Reich, that with the masochist there exists a lack of capacity to increase the tension. In reality such a state can occasionally come about as the result of the fear of the excitement if the fear of the end-pleasure has become too great. It is also not correct, as Reich assumes, that every stronger pleasure is immediately inhibited and transformed into displeasure, so that end-unrest takes the place of end-pleasure. That is only the final result of this course of development. Originally the increase in tension was very much desired, so long as it did not lead to orgasm. It is just the insight into the significance of the suspense factor that permits of no further doubt as to this. The increase in tension, however, permits the anxiety also to increase, so that every indication of increased excitement is reacted to with the urgent danger signal.

It is then only the extension and displacement of the anxiety that causes every increase of tension to appear as undesired, until finally impotence is reached. The masochist has followed the same method in this course of development as was taken by the ascetics of early Christianity who did not permit their will power to stand the test of the sight of temptation, but carefully avoided every such occasion. The orgasm, however, is feared because it brings the threat of castration and death.

We now understand better the nature of the suspense factor. It is, so-to-speak, a tension within a tension—wheels within wheels. Its double need—between anxiety and pleasure—is determined by the doubt as to whether a higher degree of access of tension and the orgasm shall be attained first or not. The attraction of over-

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stepping the forbidden boundary is impelling enough, but just as strong or stronger is the fear of the results of flouting the prohibition. The suspense feeling is thus in no way pleasant in the beginning, it only becomes so because to some degree it is next best —in a way in place of the orgasm. Instead of the pleasure which brings with it an anxiety, there now appears an anxiety which produces a pleasure. When masochism has once been instituted, it can then come about that this anxiety is secondarily desired and enjoyed.

By comparing the course of the excitement in other perversions, we come to recognize in suspense a characteristic of masochism. The disturbance in the mounting to a climax either does not permit the end-pleasure, causing it to go over into a plateau or transforms its character even to the opposite, into discontent.

Up to this point we have considered the suspense factor only as developing its effectiveness in sexual intercourse in the absence of masochistic practices. When the individual has not experienced punishment, abuse or pain before sexual gratification the intervention of the suspense factor will inhibit the attainment of end-pleasure. There is thus an alternative: preliminary punishment, humiliation or pain—orgasm; or, no preliminary pain—suspense and no orgasm, eventually end-discontent. Expressed in another way: if the masochist has experienced directly physical pain or psychic discomfort he is quite capable of having the orgasm and of feeling intense pleasure. The climax of excitation is normal. If no serious discomfort has preceded, there appears in place of the excitation climax a suspense, which later leads to disturbance of potency and finally to impotence. This picture of the alternative is correct beyond a doubt. It can be demonstrated in any case of masochistic attitude.

A correction is necessary only insofar as the suspense factor is demonstrable also in those cases where masochistic practices have preceded the sexual satisfaction. And, of course, in quite an unexpected place, in a displacement. Let us pursue the description of a masochistic scene: a patient referred to above goes to a prostitute, induces her to abuse him, has to undress and receive a blow on the buttocks; with this an ejaculation follows. So far the gross

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description of the scene. A closer consideration of details will convince us that the scene falls clearly into two portions: into an expectation of a blow to which the whole of the preceding scene leads up, and into the masochistic practice itself. The abuse, the verbal threats accompanied by expressive gestures, finally the minutes long waiting for the blow is more important libidinously than is the blow itself. In many cases the excitement attained during the period of being scolded or threatened suffices to bring on the end-pleasure.

The psychic character of this waiting corresponds in every respect to the suspense. It swings between the pleasurable and the fearful. Paradoxically speaking, it is a pleasing anxiety in face of punishment or humiliation. We have then to make a correction. In the perverse practice also the suspense feeling is experienced and can be objectively observed.

A comparison of the suspense feeling in the masochistic scene and in the phantasy results in the following: in the first case the tension vacillating between pleasure and anxiety is directed towards punishment, being humiliated or shamed; in the second case towards the terminal climax. The end-pleasure is not attained (at least, not without preliminiary activities) or else is transformed into terminal discontent. We understand better now the significance of phantasy for masochism. The tension in it (likewise in sexual intercourse with masochistic phantasies) is initially pleasurable and receives its altered character from the force of the accompanying anxiety. To paraphrase it: the suspense factor is now revealed as the former sexual tension transformed under the influence of unconscious anxiety. In the masochistic scene the anxiety has already become something pleasant, one of the later developmental phases. An anxiety-ridden pleasure has become a pleasurable anxiety. From here it is only a step to a point of view which gives on the basis of this conception of suspense feeling a quite altered idea of masochism. Masochism is not characterized by a pleasure in pain but by a *pleasure in the expectation of pain.* The stress, which originally was given to the pleasure in the climactic excitement and to the orgasm has been shifted to the anxious anticipation and the anxiety has taken on its character: it has itself become the pleasure.

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Comparing the fore-pleasure with the feeling of suspense shows that the fore-pleasure anticipates an end-pleasure, is in some measure a sampling of the pleasure-premium of the orgasm. The suspense feeling is this too but at the same time it is also an anticipation in the present discontent of the future punishment, a kind of sampling of the dish which one would like to have and which is forbidden. It is thus fore-pleasure plus fore-displeasure and ultimately is transformed more and more into the latter.

But how is it that this fore-displeasure is finally sought after in masochism? All of us will when we expect a pain or physical hurt, try to push away what we fear, we do not wish to bring it about, nor wish to receive any advance on a coming pain. Surely no one who faces a severe operation would cut his finger in order to have a presentiment of the future hurt. Yet under certain conditions everyone has done something quite comparable. Consider the following: I notice a toothache, one of those sudden twinges which come and go without warning. I make a resolution to go to the dentist as soon as I have the time. A half hour later the twinge reoccurs. I know it will come again and I must go immediately to the dentist. I move my tongue and bring it tentatively into the neighborhood of the troublesome place. The contact hurts. A few minutes later I repeat this although I know quite well it will hurt. I do this and surely not for the purpose of persuading myself that the tooth still hurts. There must be some other motive. I have a fear that the tooth will begin aching again of its own accord. I touch it with the tongue in order to prepare or to harden myself. To put it otherwise, in order to avoid anxiety or not to let it become so great. In this way I seek out something about which I have an anxiety—out of anxiety. I take on a bit of pain that I may not suddenly or unprepared be overcome by it. Here then is a sort of intentional seeking of the fore-displeasure, a kind of masochistic act in miniature.

Here is another and more plausible example: a woman patient whose masochistic tendencies have clearly worked over into various neurotic elaborations, reported that already in childhood she had observed in herself a sort of masochism. When at an early age she was put into the bath and the governess had left, perhaps to get a towel, she turned on the cold water faucet just a little and let a few drops run down her arm. This always gave

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her an unpleasant-pleasant feeling. It is hardly necessary to remark that the little girl hated very much the touch of cold water and was afraid of it. She knew beforehand that soon would come the final sponging off with cold water, so she anticipated it by letting a few drops fall on her arm. We will not hesitate to assume that the little girl acted so because she was especially afraid. She sought out the fore-displeasure to be the better fortified against the greater discomfort or not to be obliged to feel too great an anxiety.

The fore-displeasure, which is here as in masochism anticipated, is thus designed to protect against a shock or a great upsurge of anxiety. In order to avoid anxiety the unpleasant is intentionally brought into being. In so far as the young girl has brought about the anxiety-stimulating circumstance in a small degree by allowing a few drops to fall on her skin she has allayed the fear. It is important that what she feared is not done to her but by her. She did it, she is the active one, the mistress of her own fate. Furthermore this anticipation by conversion of the passive into the reflexive includes an important time factor: the tension is spread out over a longer time and thus prepared for. When the child turned on the cold water faucet, a shock was expected. When she let a few drops run down her arm, she had lessened the tension by spreading it over a longer time. She had by preparing herself psychologically, avoided a sudden heaping up of tension. Through the longer time available to her in this way, she had transformed a strong excitement into a moderate one.

The factors mentioned in this case can, moreover, be demonstrated in any case of masochism. The fore-displeasure does not come as a surprise but is brought on at the will of the patient, indeed by his instructions. He induces, even arranges, what shall be done to him in the way of unpleasantnesses. It shall not be done to him against his will. What happens to him or what he suffers in punishment or humiliation, happens at a time chosen by himself, timed according to his own rhythms and in an order he selected. The excitement is diffused over a definite period and by this means the anxiety is diminished or eliminated. Overlooking this factor clouds our insight into why, as has often been commented on, the masochist shows no anxiety phenomena. No

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anxiety can develop for he has carried into effect just his intention of avoiding it. Instead of suffering anxiety he has himself produced the suffering, instead of having to be afraid of humiliation, abuse and punishment, he, master of his own destiny, has brought them on himself. He has anticipated all these things and all their terrors. Accordingly the masochistic mechanism is in its intentions a flight towards something lying ahead.

The sensation of suspense has disclosed itself to be the final phase of an anxiety development. And just the study of this factor enables us to understand how it is that the masochist succeeds in the perversion in preventing the development of anxiety. To escape the fear of punishment and humiliation, he arranges these himself. The comprehension of this fact leads us further, it discloses as an important factor in masochism the psychic preparedness for discontent. It can be said that the masochistic pleasure resides more in this expectation of discontent than in the discontent itself.

This insight into the workings of the suspense factor helps the understanding from another side of the possibility of the development of masochism. If one of its most essential features is the avoidance of anxiety, then it becomes intelligible that later out of pleasure arises discontent and finally a postponing of the end-pleasure and at last a renunciation of it. A comparison here becomes pertinent, everyone has at some time or other slipped badly in making a highjump. Later an occasion to jump reoccurs, a run is made, the point for the attempt is reached, the jumping movements are made but at the last moment by some mysterious means the jump itself is inhibited. Surely an unconscious anxiety at the memory of the previous failure has interfered. Subsequently one again comes to the point of jumping but now the inhibition occurs earlier, before the getting set to jump, still later it occurs during the run until finally one gives up the attempt entirely, since rightly a slip is a foregone conclusion.

But what gives us the right to draw on such a comparison? The countless experiences in analytic practice with perversions and masochistic characters, and not least the reconstructions to which memories and symptoms of the analysand force us. These constructions, however, find a sort of indirect confirmation, when we

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succeed in the course of an analysis in opening up the path in a contrary direction. Then is disclosed for example how an impotent man with masochistic phantasies on his way back to recovery passes through all the phases that have been sketched here. In certain cases of an atypical sort it can be demonstrated that not the development of an anxiety was avoided but the outburst of a strong affect of terror.

We have said that masochistic practices were offshoots of phantasies; they show that the masochist is seeking the way of return to reality. To avoid anxiety he assumes beforehand the burden of suffering, displeasure or punishment which threatens him, in order to be able to enjoy a sexual pleasure. In this sense he represents a pendant to the ascetic or saint who has visitations of sexuality. The masochist atones in advance. He scourges himself or has himself scourged that he may then without punishment have the orgasm. The ascetic punishes himself because of the emerging sexual excitement. With the masochist the discontent is wiped out by the sexual gratification, with the ascetic or saint the sexual excitement by the discontent or by the self-punishment. By association and contrast the two types become clearer if one opposes concrete examples of each. There are countless typical cases in which a corporal chastisement, which the masochist inflicts on himself flows over into sexual excitement and orgasm. It seems that a definite degree of pain or displeasure must be reached so that the transition to a heightened sexual excitement may occur. Thus, perhaps one must be beaten for such and such a length of time, say until he bleeds from many wounds, before the orgasm can occur.

The Demonstrative Feature

I promised to describe the characteristic features which cannot be missed in any case of masochism. The surpassing importance of phantasy seems to me the primary feature, the factor of suspense taking second place. The third striking feature will for the moment be called the demonstrative, a designation which will be justified later. By it, I mean that in no case of masochism can the fact be overlooked that the suffering, the discontent, humiliation or abuse is shown, brought to notice so to speak, put in a show

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case. In many instances this feature shows up so clearly that one may wonder why it has been so long under-estimated. Many observers, as for example, *J. Lampl, K. Menninger,* have referred to it in passing since they have commented on the narcissistic character of masochism. I will later show that not only this designation seems misleading but also—what's in a name—that it represents a wrong conception.

In the practices of the masochist the exposure and display of the person with all their psychic concommittant phenomena play so great a role that a constant relation between masochism and exhibitionism could be spoken of. If I prefer to designate this feature rather as demonstrative then it is for two reasons. In the first place to avoid a certain misunderstanding by which the idea of exhibitionism is associated only with the display of what is believed to be beautiful or that which is stimulating. And secondly under the term 'demonstrative' reference is intended to be made also to a hidden meaning of such display, which I shall hope to make clear in what follows. Here it will suffice to remark that in an example such as that of Rousseau, who was impelled despite all shame to show to any lady passing by his naked buttocks, not only does the exhibitionistic nature of masochism become clear but also that important closely related feature which I shall designate as the *provocative.* The showing off or desire to let the other see would indeed be furthered by the sexually gratifying punishment.

Occasionally the demonstration in phantasy—or less frequently in reality—suffices to touch off the masochistic satisfaction. I would remind you here of the girl with the phantasy of the butcher. The lying-there-naked which she felt as most degrading and humiliating, was one of the most pleasurable moments, especially when she imagined that none of the butchers paid any particular attention to her. In the third example referred to above of the man who went to the prostitute and had himself beaten because he was "bad," the undressing and exposure of the backside was almost as important as the blow which followed. Here is to be noticed what distinguishes such demonstration or exhibition from narcissism. At first glance it seems immaterial whether what is to be seen by the other or others is imagined to be beautiful or ugly.

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While in some cases the body will be felt by the exhibitionist to be striking and stimulating it appears in other cases to be felt as terrifying or disgusting. Closer consideration shows, of course, a more complicated situation. In the cases with conscious pride in their own bodies or who take especial pleasure in it, the punishment or the pain which follows is perceived as more severe or the disgrace as deeper. Where the body seems hateful to the person, the presentation or depictation of it being felt to be disgusting, this feeling itself will become a feature of the masochistic pleasure and effectively contributes to the sexual excitement. We will recall the example of the extensive sacrificial phantasies of the man who took his sexual satisfaction in imagining that young men were being offered up to Moloch or to an Aztec god. For this terrible death in the fire only the most beautiful youths of the tribe were chosen. They were shown to the whole of the people. Here, of course, a narcissistic pride could be spoken of in relation to the idea that these youths—all "doubles" of the daydreamer—stood before the idol "with nothing on but a smile." Their beautiful bodies stirred the admiration of all. They themselves, however, considered it as a distinction that they should be called to suffer the terrible death in the flames. The severe chastisement in this phantasy may be contrasted with the deep feeling of impotent humiliation and degradation in the phantasies of a young girl of being watched while urinating or defecating which, nevertheless, brought her a clearly masochistic pleasure. In place of bodily hurt or pain these people often put on a shameful or degrading exhibitionistic display of bodily or psychic awkwardness which in their imagination has a stimulating effect. The "embarrassing situation" is enjoyed with the same anxious-pleasant feeling which accompanies bodily punishment.

With this we are already at the threshold leading to the desexualized forms of masochism. With these there can be no question of perversion in the grosser meanings of the word, but where the masochism becomes a dominating attitude to life, this demonstrative feature is clearly recognizable. When *Wilhelm Reich* in his book finds a close relation between masochism and inhibited exhibitionism he has allowed himself to be duped by the external aspects of the phenomena. A conscious suppression of exhibition

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does not, of course, contradict a hidden and yet victorious tendency in the opposite direction. The resultant of such conflicting forces is at most a demonstrative concealment or an exhibition with reversed indications. A young woman, who as a girl had elaborate masochistic phantasies gave no indication of these but she neglected no opportunity of any sort however unfitted to emphasize that she could do nothing, had no distinct character, was inferior to other women in charm and desirability. It was as if she would show to the whole world her complete insignificance. But just in this was the striking feature, she always referred to her lack of attractiveness at the moment when she could have taken pride in it. The onlooker or listener is here also a *conditio sine qua non.* Such display or glorification of one's own defects does not accord well with an inhibition of exhibitionism. It is not to be understood why these "inferior" people do not practice a reticence or discretion as might be expected of them. The self-abasement and self-depreciation which *Reich* feels is so striking, exists indeed but the essential thing in it is that it is so *strikingly present.* The young woman for instance, of whom I have just spoken, was once asked if she could typewrite. "Not very good, really not at all," she answered. Next day she mentioned as if she had just happened to think of it, that she possessed a diploma in typewriting. So there is often a divided or ambiguous attitude. One might say, "Pride cometh after the fall." The demonstrative factor in those who are on the quest for suffering is so general that it can be found also where opposing psychic tendencies have forced displacements, hybrid forms and reaction formations. Generally the result, as already mentioned, is a compromise formation of showing and hiding. That sounds as paradoxical as it is. But just such remarkable blends are to be met with in life. Take a commonplace example: a man enters a room in which a woman sits very free and easy with crossed legs. She will certainly immediately alter her position, and pull down the edge of her skirt. Now there are cases in which this so happens that the pudicity is stressed or demonstrated. The movements which she makes can betray a mixture of such wishes to display and to hide. There is to be encountered in masochism such blends from the most refined to the grossest forms. The following instance made quite an impression on me: a patient had to go to a gala concert of a famous orchestra. She wished to wear

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her new evening dress and the pearls she had recently been given. But, she resisted this with the thought that in the small city so magnificent a toilette would attract atention. After long hesitation she decided—*pour épater les bourgeois*—to go in her usual clothes. The result, naturally was that she was the only woman there not in evening dress and was critically inspected by all. Now she had really attracted attention which was just what she had sought to avoid. She felt humiliated and yet superior. In this public display, the realization of which might be called almost cunning, a *coincidentia oppositorum* was reached. The goal was still—to be noticed; the result was—she was looked at. The original wish struggling with its counter-impulse, had led to a masochistic compromise expression, to a sort of negative demonstration or an exhibitionism with reversed signs.

A lawyer had for years visited the sessions of a professional club without once participating in the discussions. Yet he had a strong desire to do so, knowing that he had something important to say. He was stopped from speaking because he asked himself how his silence was taken and got the answer: he really attracted attention by saying nothing. A clear tendency to stand at the center of attention shows up here behind the appearance of modesty. Comparatively speaking: a violet lets it be generally known that it blooms in concealment. Every critical investigation of the psychology of masochism shows, that there can be no question of a dominating inhibition of exhibitionism, for at least there is an exhibition with reversed signs. In the cases of self-depreciation and self-derogation, diffidence and pretended stupidity one can see the same showing off, the desire to shine with one's own defects and failings. It is striking none the less that so many masochists are not ashamed of their weaknesses and bad qualities but openly glory in them.

Everyone knows instances in which persons bear their suffering so-to-speak, for show. Suffering in masochism clearly has such an external aspect directed towards the environment, a facade designed for the bystanders. If not noticed by this surrounding world the suffering loses much of its enjoyable character. Anyone who has attentively followed the reports of this type of case will recognize this: "It is half pleasure, half complaint," might be said with the Mörike-Song. The relaxation of this attention directed at the

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suffering can liberate bitterness and anger. A woman patient whose attacks usually produced in her family a great apprehension, once lay on the sofa moaning. When her sighs found no responsive sympathy she got up and dressed without giving to her pains any significance whatever. A member of the ordinarily over-solicitous family who for once had not been concerned over the invalid, heard her mutter to herself: "Well, nothing doing."

Not uncommonly there is that mixture of motives with the desire to conceal in the form which signifies suffering in silence. In many cases of a pronounced type in which the individual has suffered injustice it is like a demonstration signifying: "I bear no malice even if my heart breaks." Such noticeable-hidden suffering being seen shall be admired for the steadfastness with which it is borne. The attention of the milieu must be attracted to this suffering. Here the question can be brought up in opposition: is there then any suffering without such demonstrative intentions? Surely, but then it is not masochistic suffering. The demonstrative characteristic is essential to masochism and is not separable from it.

Nor is this demonstrative feature restricted to the physical field. One thinks of figures such as the Russian writers *Dostojewski* and *Tolstoi,* who showed a real voluptuousness in exposing their failings and weaknesses to the whole world. The same feature can be rediscovered here. The association of feminine and moral masochism in the average demonstrative character is easily proven. *Rousseau's* "Confessions," and "Correspondance," Baudelaire's reveling in masochistic phantasies and his compulsion to confess ("Coeur mis à nu") may be referred to as lying close to hand. The same combination of characteristics is to be found in the fields of history of religion. The martyrdom of the early Christians bears striking testimony to the fact that their suffering was seen as "ad Christi majorem gloriam." These witnesses to the faith desired witnesses of their martyrdom, they liked to show their wounds and degradation. They wished the whole world to know of their passionate zeal. One is reminded of that Stylites—he appears in Anatole France's impressive description—the holy man who displayed his asceticism, his privations and penitences high over the marketplace for all eyes to see. A direct line leads from such behavior to that of Hindu Fakirs and Mohammedan dervishes

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with their selfmartyrdom. One's own suffering and horrible death should be watched by a great or illustrious crowd. Instances that might be brought up as examples to the contrary as seen in individual ascetics and martyrs, on examination turn out to be only apparent contradictions. Even for the solitary monk, for the holy Hieronymus in the desert, for Saint Anthony in the Thebais and for all hermits who subjected themselves to such fearful flagellation, there was the one and all important witness: God. To Him they wished to show how they suffered for Him, to prove to Him how they punished themselves for their sins.

However genuine the penitence or the voluntary suffering is, it could not exist without a public. In most cases it has the character of showing off and does not dispense with a certain theatrical flavor. This demonstrative note is not restricted to the masochistic individual. It is to be found again in the behavior of certain groups and peoples, whose destiny has ordained a past and present of suffering. In the life of these peoples the association of the ideas of being loved and punished shows up again on a higher, often religious, plane. The suffering of the folk is conceived to be a sign of a definite mission, as a token that to them has fallen a significant role in human history. The sexualization of punishment is demonstrable in the psychic life of groups as of individuals. "God loves him whom He chastens." So it is that a race with a particularly tragic history regards itself as a chosen people, whom God especially loves. Here is the folk-psychological analogue of the child's idea: father beats me and loves me. The secret pride in suffering is revealed here: it will be taken as a distinction or as a more significant testimony. The hope for an ultimate triumph can lead to a temptation to indulge in an orgy of suffering. The increase of deprivation and of suffering betokens the close proximity of the day of salvation and victory over the enemy. So in the practices of the perverse the increase of pain can be taken as indicating an imminent orgasm. Only apparently will it be welcomed as pleasurable pain. In reality the pain is bowed to as the phase preceding the pleasure. The distinction is this, in the psychic life of the perverse the sexual factor, in the psychic life of groups and masses the social factor stands in the foreground. In sum then, the masochism or rather the masochistic attitude of religious and

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national groups shows the same demonstrative behavior we see in individuals.

To return to the individual psychic life we have to add that the same characteristic cannot be missed in the transformation from perverse to desexualized masochism. In self-depreciation and self-derision before others this feature reappears. Many of these people even when alone behave unlike the queen in the fairy tale: "Mirror, mirror on the wall, who is stupidest and ugliest in all the land?" The attention of others must be drawn to the ego through clumsiness and bad conduct, indeed even by criminal acts. In one case I could study such a transition in detail. A man in middle life who had for years only a masochistic sexual gratification, during the analysis dropped his perversion and attained a normal sexual life. His character had, however, slowly undergone a noticeable development. He went much into society and greatly amused his friends and associates by retaling many experiences in which he appeared as the boob or poor fish. He produced a constant stream of witticisms—killing ones moreover more often than not—which made unmerciful fun of his own stupidity, tactlessness or egotism. Generally he simply played the clown whose job it is to make others laugh at himself. Out of the sexual perversion had arisen, so to speak, a social one. His masochism had persisted in assuming the role of a Schlemihl, a self-deriding wit. The self-depreciation had become a social mask. In displaying his own worthlessness, in cynicism directed at his own ego, he brought in again the self-demonstration. Where earlier he had exposed his buttocks in the whipping scene, he now presented himself in his psychic nudity. I would not like at this point to neglect stressing, that consideration of the result of such psychic development leads to valuable psychological insight into the personality of wits—particularly of that type which turns the shafts against itself—as well as into the genesis of the intentionally comic. Thus the production of laughter by a self-recognition before the world of defects is a kind of masochistic demonstration. Certainly it is no contradiction, that such intentional demonstration of weakness and stupidity occasionally discloses, as in the comical figures of Falstaff and Don Quixote, the masochistic character of suffering. So we find in the clown often enough the peculiar mingling of disclosure and concealment. "Laugh, Pagliacco, make foolish faces . . ." sings Leon-

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cavallo's hero. But that laugh should not merely conceal suffering, it should also betray it. Making people laugh, is only the special form of masochistic gratification in the comical individual.

An objection easily disposed of, is based on the fact that the definitely perverse can develop out of solitary practices. Self-flagellation before a mirror is not an infrequent practice with some young people. In one case the patient who brought on an orgasm in this manner, had to see in the mirror the bloody weals he had produced on his buttocks by beating. The solitude is, to be sure real, but not psychologically actual. The person concerned phantasies a spectator, is himself that spectator many times. This imagined witness has to look on at the exposure and beating and share the pleasure. He cannot be left out for he is the carrier of the pleasure bringing action. As in self-pity where unconsciously another person (mother, father) is phantasied as present and sympathizing as they once actually did when they saw us in trouble so here in the practices of masochism in solitude an active onlooker is essential. For the rest it can easily be guessed how such mirror-beating scenes come about. They are attempts primarily pictured only in phantasy to put into execution a situation in which the one person has taken over the role of the second. Such attempts signify a step away from phantasy and towards the realization in practice of a masochistic scene with a partner who will later actually be sought for. At this point we are reminded of what was said earlier as to the significant and primary role of phantasy in masochism.

Perhaps it would be well at this point to offer some justification for the designation "demonstrative" as applied to the just described characteristic, and at the same time, to differentiate it from analogous designations. It has been said already that the word "exhibitionistic" is not adequate because it presupposes that the show-off is proud of what he displays as if it were beautiful or magnificent. This, on the contrary, is not the case with either perverse or moral masochists. Much rather do they consciously feel their exposure or degradation to be shameful and unworthy. In the best case one could speak only of an exhibitionism with reversed signs as with the Gueux, that Dutch nobility who seized on a designation once abusive ('gueux' means 'beggar') to make it afterwards a term of honor and wore small silver or copper begging

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bowls on their hats and belts to show they belonged to the order. Even if one could—with these restrictions—designate the typical feature as exhibitionistic, it would still be wrong to coordinate it with narcissism as many observers have done. (*Lampl, Menninger*) I have described how the tendency of the masochist passes on to an actual exposing of himself for the sake of attracting attention. We will for the moment abstain from deciding whether this is to receive punishment or evidence of love from the other. It is quite puzzling to me, how one can call such behavior narcissistic. We understand by this term an attitude of being in love with the self. As its most certain index or most visible expression appears the characteristic of self-satisfaction. The beautiful youth of the Greek myth who fell in love with his mirror image had certainly no need to draw the attention of others to himself. He was immersed in his own looks and cared nothing about the rest of the world. How different an impression the masochist produces on us. His self display and showing off have indeed every characteristic of the aspiration to make himself noticeable. His conduct is directly the opposite of a narcissistic demeanor. It would be much more correct to say, it is evident the narcissism of these masochistic persons is deranged in the deepest levels since such great exertions are made to draw the attention of others to themselves. The typical attitude of the masochist, which has been described above, could be called narcissistic with as great justification as comparing a gourmet who gives himself up in solitude to the enjoyment of reading about foods to the man who, with his inflammatory placards, parades in front of a hunger demonstration. The onesidedness and lack of discrimination so frequently to be met with in analytic literature, the to me often terrifying misuse of analytic terminology is shown in such giving of names and misleading characterizations.

The designation "demonstrative" for the pathognomonic feature was selected because of all possible choices it can give best an idea of the typical behavior just described. It seems to me furthermore the most neutral term, since it says nothing as to the aim striven for by the masochistic showing off. For this reason also I would renounce the unambiguous term "exhibitionism." So when I wish to specify the goal which the demonstrative feature tries to attain I would speak neither of the exhibitionistic nor of the narcissistic

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nature of masochism. A long continued and ever renewed critical observation of the manifold phenomena of masochism shows that the first and most essential goal of the demonstration is universally the same. It can also be conceived as a primary one and be named. The demonstrative feature has the unconscious intention, many times also capable of becoming conscious, of liberating definite reactions in the surroundings: or better of evoking them. I would call this feature "provocative." The demonstration is thus on the psychological side a provocation. What it would provoke, how it attains its goal, and what concealed meanings it has, will be considered later. If I do not on this occasion pursue this theme any further it is because we have here to do only with the universal and typical features of masochism. The provocatory character of the masochistic attitude, however, shows already its intimate relationship to sadistic strivings.

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